- 💬 Send a message in the `#ask-a-mentor` channel in our discord
- 🏢 Visit the dedicated mentor room at **ENB 116**

🔥 Social Activity - Hack & Chill

Saturday, March 27th: 9:00PM - 11:30PM

Take a break from hacking and join **Hack & Chill** for a fun, relaxed night with other participants.

Enjoy poker and blackjack tables, casual card games, and interactive activities like Human Bingo, Rock Paper Scissors, and Imposter. You can also join Kahoot or grab the mic for karaoke.

A great chance to recharge, have fun, and connect before getting back to building 🚀

💵 Challenges & Prizes

Excited to announce that we have over **$8,000 in Prizes** this year!

There are **General** and **Sponsor** challenges. Everyone is automatically qualified for the general challenges, meaning that every project will be considered for each of these tracks! Sponsor challenges, however, will have to be opted-in by **YOU** to be considered.

🥇 General Challenges & Prizes

▼ **Best Overall 1st: IPad A16 Chip (11in - 128gb)**

Awarded to the top team with the most outstanding overall project, demonstrating excellence in innovation, technical execution, impact, and presentation.

▼ **Best Overall 2nd: 50” 4K Insignia Smart TV**

Given to the runner-up team whose project shows strong creativity, functionality, and overall quality across judging criteria.

- **Best Overall 3rd: Soundcore Anker Q30 Headphones**

  Recognizes the third-place team with an impressive, well-executed project that stands out in design and technical performance.

- **Most Innovative Hack: Keychron K2 Pro 75%**

  Awarded to the team with the most original and forward-thinking solution that introduces a unique idea or creative approach.

- **Best AI Hack: Snaptain - S5C Elite 1080p Drone with Remote Controller - Black**

  Recognizes the project that best integrates artificial intelligence to solve a real-world problem in an impactful way.

- **Best Design Hack: Fujifilm Instax Mini SE**

  Awarded to the team with the most visually polished, user-friendly, and thoughtfully designed project.

- **Best Beginner Hack: BENFEI Laptop Stand with USB C 7in1 Docking Station**

  Given to the top project built primarily by first-time hackers, showcasing strong effort, learning, and execution.

🎯 Sponsor Challenges & Prizes

▼ **Google Cloud Challenge: Building a Self-Healing World with Google ADK**

The Challenge:

Our world faces "Wicked Problems"—crises too complex, too fast, or too data-heavy for a single human (or a single chatbot) to solve. Your mission is to build a **Multi-Agent Ecosystem** using the Google ADK and A2A protocol that doesn't just "chat" about a problem, but autonomously **observes, analyzes, and acts** to create measurable social impact.

The Goal:

Build a "System of Agents" that solves a global-scale issue in Climate, Equity, Health, or Disaster Response. Don't build a tool; build a **workforce for good.** We are not here to build chatbots. We are here to engineer **Autonomous Systems of Action.** Your goal is to solve a "Wicked Problem" by creating a distributed workforce of agents that can observe, reason, and act across the **A2A (Agent-to-Agent)** network.

To drive the **ADK** and **Parallel/Looping** requirements, your rubric should reward the *sophistication* of the agentic logic, not just the fact that it exists.

Judging Criteria:

1. Architectural Sophistication (The "Brain" Power) - 30%

- **The Workflow Requirement:** Does the solution use ParallelAgent to handle high-velocity data or LoopAgent for iterative refinement and self-correction?
- **A2A Interoperability:** Does the agent reach out to other "Specialist" agents (the Handshake) to fill gaps in its own knowledge?
- **Efficiency:** Does the parallel architecture actually save time or improve the "Moonshot" outcome?

2. Social Impact & Moonshot Vision - 30%

- **Scalability:** Could this agentic system manage a city's power grid, or coordinate a country's disaster relief?
- **Sustainability Goal Alignment:** Does the "Vibe" of the project align with a major global challenge (UN SDGs)?
- **Actionability:** Does the agent actually *do* something (e.g., call a tool, update a database, send an alert) rather than just summarizing text?

3. Technical Rigor & "Googliness" - 20%

- **ADK Mastery:** Effective use of agent.json (Agent Cards) for discovery and **MCP** for grounding in real-world data.
- **Deployment:** Is the agent live and reachable via a public Google Cloud URL?
- **Reliability:** How does the agent handle "Tool Space Interference" or errors in the loop?

4. The Pitch & The "Trace" - 20%

- **The Visualization:** Did the team use the **ADK Dev UI** to show the judges the literal "thoughts" and "parallel actions" of the agents?
- **The Handshake:** Did they successfully demonstrate an A2A connection between disparate agents?

Improvements to "Go Big"

1. **Introduce "Agent Roles":** Tell hackers they aren't building "an app." They are building a **Specialist**. One team builds the "Satellite Analyst," another builds the "Logistics Coordinator." The real winners will be those whose agents talk to each other via A2A.
2. **The "Live Feed" Constraint:** Force the "Moonshot" to be grounded. "Your agent must use a real-world API (Weather, News, Finance) as its trigger." This prevents "toy" projects.
3. **The "Self-Correction" Bonus:** Offer bonus points for any LoopAgent that identifies its own hallucination or error and re-runs the task. This proves they understand **autonomy** over simple **automation**.

Prizes:

1st: $1000 Google Cloud Developer Credits

2nd: $500 Google Cloud Developer Credits

3rd: $250 Google Cloud Developer Credits

▼ **Oracle Challenge: Technology in Service of Humanity**

Problem Statement

We live in an age of remarkable technological capability — and yet loneliness is rising, mental health is in crisis, accessibility gaps persist, and countless people fall through the cracks of systems that were never designed with them in mind.

Your challenge: use AI and machine learning to close the gap between human need and human connection.

The problems worth solving are all around us. A caregiver who is too exhausted to ask for help. A student who struggles silently because no one noticed. A person with a disability navigating a world not built for them. An elderly neighbor who hasn't spoken to anyone in days. These are not edge cases — they are the everyday reality for millions of people.

We're asking you to build something that genuinely helps. Not a demo for its own sake, but an AI-powered solution rooted in empathy — one that listens better, reaches further, or acts more thoughtfully than what exists today.

What does success look like? A working prototype that addresses a real, human-centered problem. Your solution should be technically sound, but its heart should be the person it serves. Judges will evaluate your work on impact potential, technical execution, and the clarity of your vision.

Judging Criteria:

Criteria	Scoring Guide
Technical Architecture (5 Points) **How well does the MVP actually work?**	**5 – Excellent:** Fully working MVP; coherent, scalable architecture; strong tool use; includes clear success metrics to measure effectiveness. **4 – Strong:** Core functions work; mostly coherent design; realistic architecture; limited but present success metrics. **3 – Adequate:** Partial functionality; plausible but unoptimized design; scalability unclear; minimal success metrics. **2 – Weak:** Mostly conceptual MVP; fragmented design; unrealistic scalability; little consideration of success metrics. **1 – Poor:** No clear working MVP; infeasible design; no defined success metrics.
Functionality & Feasibility (5 Points) **Can the MVP realistically be developed further?**	**5 – Excellent:** Realistic, implementable solution; clear roadmap; viable resources/data; AI appropriately augments humans; key risks addressed. **4 – Strong:** Mostly feasible with minor assumptions; roadmap present; AI largely supportive; challenges partially addressed. **3 – Adequate:** Feasible in parts; unclear assumptions; high-level roadmap; AI/human role vague; risks noted but weakly solved. **2 – Weak:** Major feasibility gaps; unrealistic roadmap; AI/human misaligned; risks not meaningfully addressed. **1 – Poor:** Not realistically feasible; no roadmap; major resource/data gaps; risks ignored.

Prize:

1st Place: LEGO Super Mario Gameboy

▼ NextEra Energy Challenge: Malware Analysis Challenge

AI-Driven Threat Detection & Response

For this challenge, teams will be provided a non-executable malware sample and tasked with building a sandboxed virtual environment to contain it. From there, teams will design and implement an AI-driven automated pipeline that analyzes the malware, extracts key behavioral and structural identifiers, and generates a recommended mitigation or remediation plan based on its findings.

The goal isn't just to detect, it's to understand and respond. Teams should aim to answer critical questions such as: